The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

6th February 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Repatriation (स्वदेश वापसी)

Meaning: The process of returning a person to their country of origin.
Synonyms: Return, restoration, reinstatement
Antonyms: Exile, banishment, displacement
Example: The government facilitated the repatriation of stranded citizens from war-torn regions.

2. Shackled (बांधा हुआ / जंजीरों से जकड़ा हुआ)

Meaning: Restrained or confined, usually with chains.
Synonyms: Handcuffed, bound, restrained
Antonyms: Freed, liberated, released
Example: The prisoners were shackled and escorted by heavily armed guards.

VOCABULARY

3. Perilous (खतरनाक)

Meaning: Full of danger or risk.
Synonyms: Hazardous, risky, treacherous
Antonyms: Safe, secure, harmless
Example: The refugees undertook a perilous journey across the ocean in search of a better life.

4. Obfuscate (उलझाना / अस्पष्ट बनाना)

Meaning: To deliberately make something unclear or difficult to understand.
Synonyms: Confuse, obscure, complicate
Antonyms: Clarify, simplify, elucidate
Example: The politician obfuscated his stance on the controversial issue.

VOCABULARY

5. Clamour (कोलाहल / ज़ोरदार माँग)

Meaning: A loud and persistent demand for something.
Synonyms: Uproar, outcry, demand
Antonyms: Silence, peace, agreement
Example: The clamour for wage hikes grew louder as inflation surged.

6. Recalcitrant (अवज्ञाकारी / हठीला)

Meaning: Resisting authority or control; uncooperative.
Synonyms: Defiant, rebellious, obstinate
Antonyms: Compliant, obedient, submissive
Example: The recalcitrant employee refused to follow company policies.

VOCABULARY

7. Malevolent (द्वेषपूर्ण / दुर्भावनापूर्ण)

Meaning: Having or showing a wish to do evil to others.
Synonyms: Malicious, hostile, vindictive
Antonyms: Benevolent, kind, compassionate
Example: The villain's malevolent schemes threatened the entire kingdom.

8. Enviable (ईर्ष्या करने योग्य)

Meaning: Highly desirable or causing envy.
Synonyms: Covetable, desirable, admirable
Antonyms: Undesirable, unimpressive, unremarkable
Example: She has an enviable reputation as a skilled and dedicated lawyer.

VOCABULARY

9. Virtuous (सदाचारी / नैतिक रूप से श्रेष्ठ)

Meaning: Having high moral standards.
Synonyms: Ethical, righteous, honorable
Antonyms: Immoral, corrupt, wicked
Example: The virtuous leader was admired for his honesty and integrity.

10. Draconian (कठोर / निर्दयी)

Meaning: Excessively harsh and severe.
Synonyms: Oppressive, stringent, authoritarian
Antonyms: Lenient, mild, merciful
Example: The government imposed draconian laws to curb illegal immigration.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Beaver away
Meaning – Work hard for a long time

2. Perk up
Meaning – Become more cheerful or energetic

3. Play around
Meaning – Behave casually or irresponsibly

4. Scrape up
Meaning – Gather something with difficulty, especially money or resources

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Rain cats and dogs

Meaning - Rain heavily

2. Big fish in a small pond

Meaning - To have a lot of influence only over a small area.

3. Be in a tight corner

Meaning - In a very difficult situation

VOCABULARY

4. Bring to light

Meaning - Disclose

5. Chew the cud

Meaning - Ponder over something

Article for Reading

A tough call: on the RBI MPC’s first policy review of 2025

The Reserve Bank of India’s Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) will conclude its first policy review of 2025 on Friday, in significantly different circumstances from its December meet. For one, the key personnel have changed. The RBI has a new Governor, with former Revenue Secretary Sanjay Malhotra replacing Shaktikanta Das soon after the last review. Deputy Governor Michael Patra, an MPC member who was in charge of monetary policy, also retired last month. With the Centre yet to name his successor, navigating this review is going to be a tad tricky for the new central bank boss, with another deputy holding additional charge of monetary policy. Second, the rupee is in a free fall of sorts. After hitting 85 to the U.S. dollar on December 19, 2024, it slipped to 86 on January 13, 2025 and crossed 87 on February 3, partly due to the third factor at work.

The strengthening dollar is driven by U.S. President Donald Trump's overdrive to 'Make America Great Again' with higher tariffs on major trade partners, and other disruptive economic plans such as exiting global tax accords, shutting aid flows, et al. One thing has not changed — the clamour for an interest rate cut from industry and government honchos. In December, this noise was heightened after a sharp growth blip in the July-September quarter when GDP grew just 5.4%. Now, with 2024-25 GDP growth downgraded to just 6.4%, and the no marked uptick in economic metrics in the December-ending quarter, growth worries remain entrenched. In the interim, there has been some back and forth between North Block and Mint Street on the factors responsible for stumbling economic activity. The Finance Ministry sought to lay some of the blame for an urban demand slump on tight monetary policy.

RBI officials, in the central bank's January bulletin, said the "one way" to spark a growth rebound and a virtuous cycle of fresh private investments, is to boost consumption through higher disposable incomes, especially for the urban middle class that has been pining for relief from food inflation. With the Budget delivering on this front with income tax cuts, the ball is back in the RBI's court. Inflation has been over 5% in the last five months, but may have eased closer to the RBI's 4% target in January. But a rate cut could also hurt the rupee further, and spur higher imported inflation. It is an unenviable situation for the new RBI chief to be in; he might be tempted to take a cue from Mr. Das who had surprised markets with a rate cut in the first review under his watch in 2019, reversing his predecessor's stance.

Summary

The Reserve Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) is set to conclude its first policy review of 2025 under significantly changed circumstances. Key leadership changes include a new RBI Governor, Sanjay Malhotra, replacing Shaktikanta Das, and the retirement of Deputy Governor Michael Patra, leaving a vacancy in the monetary policy role. The rupee has weakened significantly against the U.S. dollar, partly due to President Trump's economic policies, which include higher tariffs and other disruptive measures. Amid concerns about slowing GDP growth and persistent inflation, there is mounting pressure on the RBI to cut interest rates. However, doing so could further devalue the rupee and increase imported inflation. The Finance Ministry and RBI have differing views on the causes of economic stagnation, with the former attributing it partly to tight monetary policy and the latter emphasizing the need for higher disposable incomes to drive consumption. With recent income tax cuts in the Budget addressing this concern, the focus shifts back to the RBI's decision, making this a challenging review for the new Governor.

Tone:

The tone of the passage is analytical and cautious, with an underlying sense of urgency and concern regarding the economic challenges facing the RBI and the Indian economy.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
What is a key reason behind the call for an interest rate cut?

a) India’s inflation rate has risen to unsustainable levels.
b) GDP growth has slowed, and disposable incomes need a boost.
c) The rupee has strengthened, reducing the need for monetary tightening.
d) Global oil prices have surged, requiring RBI intervention.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
What is a potential risk of the RBI cutting interest rates?

a) It could lead to excessive credit growth and economic overheating.
b) It could trigger a financial crisis similar to 2008.
c) It could weaken the rupee further, increasing imported inflation.
d) It could lower food inflation significantly, hurting farmers.
e) None of the above

Question 3:
What can be inferred about the relationship between the Finance Ministry and the RBI regarding economic policy?

a) They completely agree on all policy measures.
b) The Finance Ministry blames the RBI for economic slowdown, while the RBI suggests other factors.
c) The RBI is under direct government control in setting interest rates.
d) The Finance Ministry does not comment on monetary policy.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

Not worth the risk: on the U.S., India and illegal emigration

The deportation of dozens of Indians, believed to be illegal immigrants in the United States, is neither surprising nor unprecedented. Over the past few years, the U.S. government has intensified its Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) operations to identify, detain, and deport individuals without proper documentation. For instance, between June and October 2024, the Department of Homeland Security reported that 1,60,000 individuals had been deported on 495 international repatriation flights to more than 145 countries, including India. However, the manner and timing should be cause for concern for New Delhi. To begin with, these deportations coincide with a major crackdown by ICE, spurred by Donald Trump's swearing-in as the U.S. President in January. He has made illegal immigration his "number one priority". India, which has one of the largest populations of illegal immigrants in the U.S., estimated at 7,25,000 undocumented individuals, will need to prepare for a significant increase in the number of returning migrants.

Second, for the first time, the use of military flights signals that the U.S. does not intend to be challenged. This move drew protests from Colombian President Gustavo Petro, particularly after reports emerged of deported migrants being shackled. The U.S. Embassy in Delhi has also made it clear that this deportation is part of a broader initiative to tighten immigration laws and enforcement, reinforcing the message that illegal migration is not worth the risk. Further, the timing, just ahead of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's U.S. visit, suggests that diplomatic efforts alone may not be enough to deter the Trump administration from pursuing such measures. This has the potential to become a bilateral flashpoint in India-U.S. relations. Accepting its citizens, provided they are verifiably Indian and have entered other countries illegally, is undoubtedly the Indian government's responsibility. However, stricter controls must be enforced to prevent Indians from embarking on perilous journeys to cross into the U.S. via Mexico and Canada.

The government must ensure that young people in States with high deportation rates (Gujarat, Punjab, and Haryana), understand that working illegally abroad is not a guaranteed path to success. Educational campaigns should highlight the dangers associated with illegal immigration. Importantly, the root causes must not be ignored. The central and State governments must address the underlying economic distress, deepening agricultural crises, social tensions, and employment shortages that push people to take such risks. Attention must be paid to those who deliberately travel to conflict zones in search of opportunities. While altering U.S. immigration policies may be difficult, the Indian government must address the reasons behind this large-scale migration with empathy and urgency.

Question 4:
What is a major challenge in discouraging Indians from illegally migrating to the U.S.?

a) Lack of awareness among young people about the dangers of illegal immigration.
b) Strict U.S. visa policies making legal migration impossible.
c) The Indian government actively encourages migration for economic reasons.
d) The absence of repatriation agreements between India and the U.S.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
What is one key reason why India should be concerned about the recent deportations of illegal immigrants from the U.S.?

a) The deportations indicate a sharp decline in U.S.-India diplomatic relations.
b) Deportations of Indian migrants have never happened before.
c) The U.S. is using military flights, signaling a more aggressive approach.
d) India does not have any undocumented immigrants in the U.S.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question

Original Text:

Twitter, now rebranded as X under Elon Musk’s leadership, is undergoing a significant transformation, with changes in its business model, content policies, and technological advancements shaping its future. The platform, once known for its role in real-time news, public discourse, and social activism, is evolving into a more comprehensive digital ecosystem, integrating financial services, AI-driven features, and enhanced monetization options. One of the key changes is Twitter’s shift toward a subscription-based model. Features like Twitter Blue (now X Premium) offer users verified status, ad-free experiences, and higher visibility for their posts. This marks a move away from ad revenue dependency and aims to create a more sustainable revenue stream.

Additionally, Musk envisions Twitter as an "everything app", integrating services like payments, video content, and AI-driven tools to expand its functionality beyond microblogging.

However, these changes come with challenges. The platform has faced criticism over content moderation, misinformation, and changes in its verification system. The relaxation of moderation policies has led to concerns about the spread of misinformation, hate speech, and declining user trust. Additionally, competition from emerging platforms like Threads and Bluesky poses a threat to Twitter’s dominance in the social media space.

The future of Twitter will depend on how well it balances innovation, user engagement, and responsible content governance. If successful, it could redefine social media by integrating AI, financial services, and multimedia content, transforming Twitter from a microblogging site into a multi-purpose digital ecosystem.

Precis

Twitter, now X, is evolving under Elon Musk with a focus on subscriptions, AI, and financial services. Moving beyond microblogging, it aims to become an "everything app", integrating payments, video content, and advanced features.

Challenges include concerns over content moderation, misinformation, and competition from new platforms. Twitter’s success will depend on balancing innovation, user trust, and responsible governance, potentially redefining the future of social media.

- **Write an email to apply for an internship at a reputed organization. Mention your qualifications, relevant skills, and reasons for choosing the organization.**

To: ……@gmail.com

Subject: Application for Internship Opportunity

Dear [Hiring Manager's Name],

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to express my keen interest in the internship opportunity at [Organization’s Name]. As a [Your Qualification, e.g., Bachelor's/Master’s student in English/Relevant Field] with a strong foundation in [mention relevant subjects or skills], I am eager to contribute to your esteemed organization while gaining hands-on experience in [specific field or department]. With my experience as a Subject Matter Expert - English at Practice Mock Edtech Pvt. Ltd., I have developed skills in content creation, mock test development, and analysis for competitive exams like IBPS PO, SSC, and regulatory bodies.

Additionally, I have honed my ability to interpret editorial-style content, design comprehension-based questions, and provide detailed grammatical explanations. My analytical mindset, attention to detail, and passion for language and assessment design make me a strong candidate for this role. I am particularly drawn to [Organization's Name] because of its reputation for excellence in [mention a specific aspect of the organization, such as research, education, publishing, or any relevant field]. The prospect of learning from industry experts and contributing to meaningful projects aligns with my career aspirations.

I have attached my resume for your review. I would appreciate the opportunity to discuss how my skills and experiences align with your internship program. Please let me know a convenient time for a conversation.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to your response.

Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Contact Information]

Match the column

1. Rain cats and dogs	A. In a very difficult situation
2. Big fish in a small pond	B. Ponder over something
3. Be in a tight corner	C. Disclose
4. Bring to light	D. Rain heavily
5. Chew the cud	E. To have a lot of influence only over a small area

Answer:

1-d

2-e

3-a

4-c

5-b

Vocabulary

1. Repatriation:
2. Shackled:
3. Perilous:
4. Obfuscate:
5. Clamour:
6. Recalcitrant:
7. Malevolent:
8. Enviable:
9. Virtuous:
10. Draconian:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: b

Explanation:

Reference: "Now, with 2024-25 GDP growth downgraded to just 6.4%, and no marked uptick in economic metrics in the December-ending quarter, growth worries remain entrenched."

The passage states that GDP growth slowed to 5.4% in Q2 2024-25, and the full-year growth estimate has been downgraded to 6.4%. It also mentions that to boost growth, higher disposable incomes are necessary.

Incorrect Options:

a) Inflation has been over 5%, but it may have eased closer to 4%.

c) The rupee has weakened, not strengthened.

d) The passage does not mention oil price surges.

2.

Ans: c

Explanation:

Reference: "But a rate cut could also hurt the rupee further, and spur higher imported inflation."

The passage warns that a rate cut could hurt the rupee further and spur higher imported inflation, which is already a concern due to the falling rupee.

Incorrect Options:

a) The passage does not mention credit growth risks.
b) There is no comparison to the 2008 financial crisis.
d) A rate cut would not directly lower food inflation to a harmful extent.

3.

Ans: b

Explanation:

Reference: "The Finance Ministry sought to lay some of the blame for an urban demand slump on tight monetary policy. RBI officials, in the central bank’s January bulletin, said the 'one way' to spark a growth rebound... is to boost consumption through higher disposable incomes."

The passage states that the Finance Ministry attributed the urban demand slump to tight monetary policy. However, the RBI countered that the best way to boost growth is to increase disposable incomes, which the Budget addressed with tax cuts.

Incorrect Options:

a) There is disagreement between the Finance Ministry and RBI.
c) The RBI operates independently in setting rates.
d) The Finance Ministry does comment on monetary policy.

4.
Ans: a
Explanation:
Reference: "The government must ensure that young people in States with high deportation rates (Gujarat, Punjab, and Haryana), understand that working illegally abroad is not a guaranteed path to success."

The passage highlights the need for educational campaigns to inform young people—especially in Gujarat, Punjab, and Haryana—that illegal immigration is not a guaranteed path to success and involves serious risks.

Incorrect Options:

b) The passage does not claim that legal migration is impossible.
c) The Indian government does not encourage illegal migration.
d) The passage does not suggest that India lacks repatriation agreements with the U.S.

5.

Ans: c

Explanation:

Reference: "For the first time, the use of military flights signals that the U.S. does not intend to be challenged."

The passage states that, for the first time, military flights have been used for deportations, demonstrating the U.S.'s firm stance on illegal immigration.

Incorrect Options:

a) The passage does not state a sharp decline in U.S.-India relations, though this could become a bilateral issue.
b) Deportations have happened before; the passage even cites past statistics.
d) India has 725,000 undocumented immigrants in the U.S.

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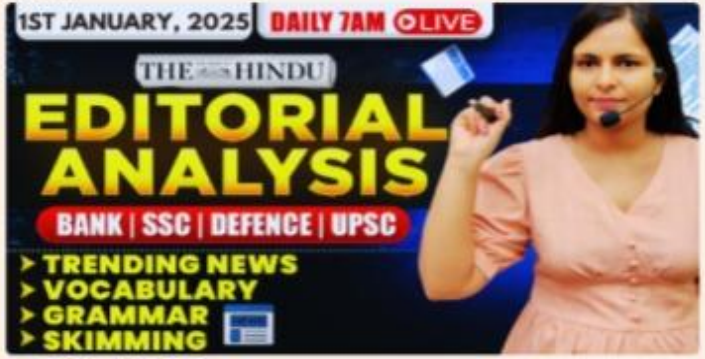

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